



Merit Education Group

Implementation Guide

Algebra 1 • Getting Started with MEG

Standard: 9.3.5.5

Standard: 9.3.5.7

Standard: 9.3.5.8

Welcome to MEG Algebra 1

Thank you for choosing Merit Education Group's Algebra 1 curriculum. This implementation guide is designed to help you get started quickly and make the most of every resource. Whether you're a first-year teacher or a veteran instructional coach, MEG gives you a complete, standards-aligned Algebra 1 program that works within your existing school structure.

What's Included

Lesson Plans

Detailed 3-phase lesson plans for every class period. Includes timing, differentiation, misconceptions, and PBIS integration points.

Slide Decks

18 fully built slide decks — one per lesson. Project-ready, LMS-agnostic. Built for 50-minute classes with embedded discussion prompts.

Guided Notes

Fill-in-the-blank notes with answer keys. Students engage actively with the material instead of transcribing from the board.

Assessments

Formative exit tickets, quiz, and two-part unit exam. 101 QTI-standard items ready to import into Canvas, Schoology, or any LMS.

PBIS Integration

Prime Time games, behavior reflection forms, and classroom management routines built

Family Resources

Unit overview letters available in English, Spanish, Somali, and Hmong. Keep families informed and engaged throughout the unit.

into every lesson. PBIS doesn't stop when math starts.

Lesson Structure — The 3-Phase Model

Every MEG Algebra 1 lesson follows a consistent 3-phase structure designed to maximize learning in a 50-minute class period:

Phase Phase 1: Activate & Explore (~16 min) 16 min min

Bell Ringer (4 min) — A warm-up problem that reviews prerequisite skills and activates prior knowledge. Students work independently while you take attendance.

Direct Instruction (6 min) — Concise, focused teaching of new content. Use the provided slide deck to guide instruction. Emphasis on vocabulary, modeling, and think-aloud strategies.

Culture & Career Spotlight (6 min) — A real-world connection that shows students why the math matters. Alternates between Ojibwe/Dakota cultural contexts and career connections (engineering, healthcare, trades, technology).

Phase Phase 2: Practice & Apply (~26 min) 26 min min

Guided Practice (8 min) — Whole-class or partner practice with teacher facilitation. 3–4 worked examples with gradual release of responsibility.

Independent Worksheet (18 min) — Tiered independent practice:

- **T1 (Foundational):** Core skill practice for all students
- **T2 (Application):** Deeper application for students ready for challenge
- **T3 (Extension):** Complex problem-solving for advanced learners

Teacher Circulates: Use the 18-minute independent work window to provide targeted support, check for understanding, and give PBIS recognition.

Phase Phase 3: Assess & Reflect (~8 min) 8 min min

Prime Time Game (5 min) — A fast-paced, low-stakes review game that reinforces lesson content. PBIS bonus points awarded for teamwork, persistence, and math talk.

Exit Ticket (2 min) — A 1–2 question formative check that tells you who mastered the objective and who needs re-engagement.

Today & Tomorrow (1 min) — A quick summary of what was learned and a preview of the next lesson. Builds continuity and anticipation.

Differentiation Philosophy

MEG Algebra 1 uses a tiered differentiation model embedded directly into every lesson — not as a separate intervention, but as the default instructional design.

T1: Foundational

Universal instruction for all students. Addresses grade-level standards with scaffolded support. Graphic organizers, sentence starters, and visual aids built in.

T2: Application

Extended thinking for students ready for more. Real-world problem-solving, multiple representations, and mathematical discourse prompts.

T3: Extension

Complex, multi-step challenges for advanced learners. Open-ended tasks, cross-curricular connections, and student-choice options.

PBIS Integration Principles

MEG embeds Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports into the lesson design itself. Rather than separate behavior management systems, our curriculum builds in natural opportunities for:

- **Recognition:** Teacher scripts for specific, timely praise during circulate time
- **Routines:** Consistent lesson structure reduces cognitive load and behavioral uncertainty
- **Relationships:** Culture & Career sections create space for student identity in math
- **Reinforcement:** Prime Time games provide immediate, positive feedback loops

For details, see the PBIS Game Master sample or visit the PBIS Framework page.

Getting Started Checklist

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| ☐ Review this implementation guide | ☐ Open the Unit 1 Scope & Sequence |
| ☐ Preview Lesson 1 slide deck | ☐ Read Lesson 1 lesson plan |
| ☐ Print Guided Notes for Lesson 1 | ☐ Prepare Prime Time card game materials |
| ☐ Print Exit Ticket slips | ☐ Post PBIS expectations anchor chart |
| ☐ Review SPED/ELL differentiation notes | ☐ Send Unit 1 Family Letter home |
| ☐ Import assessment items into your LMS | ☐ Schedule Unit 1 Exam on your calendar |

Need Support?

The MEG team is available for implementation support, coaching calls, and professional development workshops. Contact us through the website or your district representative for:

- On-site or virtual PD sessions
- Co-teaching and modeling demonstrations
- Data analysis and intervention planning
- Customization support for your school's PBIS framework